

TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON CONSERVATION COMMISSION

MEETING Minutes

For the Westhampton Conservation Commission meeting on May 6, 2026 at 7:00 P.M. in their office at the Westhampton Town Hall, #1 South Road Westhampton

Members Present: Fred, Brad, Bill, Alyson, Jessica (recording)

Also in attendance: Sean Jeffords and Karina Swenson, Ishmael Jeffords, Jonah Jeffords, Gideon Jeffords; David Cameron (wetlands consultant), on behalf of property owners

1. Call to Order: 7:00 pm

2. Accept Minutes meeting of: March 25, 2026 and April 15, 2026

3. Review correspondence: Sean and Katrina Jeffords, 412 Main Rd.; Mark Stinson (DEP), re: 412 Main Rd. and 70 Peninsula Rd. and Perry Hill Rd. NOI; Kate Bednaz, re: NOI hearing 70 Peninsula Rd. PIL; Alyson and Meehan, re: NOI; Alyson and Melissa Nuttelman; Lee Halasz (Kestrel Land Trust), re: Special meeting May 13th

4. Old/Ongoing/Unfinished Business:

Meehan NOI? Any answer after inquiry?; No response, Alyson will contact again; According to Mark Stinson (DEP), a new NOI will need to be filed if moving forward

Alyson spoke to Melissa Nuttelman—no drawdown at PIL;

412 Main Rd., RFA violation/Enforcement Order/Restoration and Remediation Plans: Sean and Karina Jeffords and their wetlands consultant present Restoration plans and future plans for the site/property:

Response to Enforcement Order: consultant believes property is stabilized with little risk of erosion; dying ash trees removed; willing to plant small trees; interested in agricultural use; “limited projects”—projects that have ability to receive waiver because they provide a public interest/benefit?; “new agriculture” is considered to be a limited project which would reduce buffer zone to 100’; Restoration Plan depends on whether it’s considered “new agriculture”; Retaining walls control erosion, stabilizing driveway considered to be an exemption (202); Some trees were removed by previous owner; They’ve removed some invasive plants; will plant more native species;

Future Plans for property: flowers, farmstand, forestry based activities (61 B); sawmill; post and beam structure education; firewood; would bring wood from elsewhere, rather than clearing the land; Special permit would likely be required for sawmill; right to farm?; check zoning

bylaws to determine regulations (not within Cons Com's jurisdiction) ; normal maintenance and improvement are exempted, but would require an NOI;

Sawmill/Lumber/firewood/educational structures; gardens and flowerbeds; livestock on hill; hay shed; pavilion; agricultural and educational activities;

Parking on property would not be permitted within 200' buffer zone--can they consider another location for parking?—more research into regulations is required; riverfront area cannot be altered without permit; existing driveway used for farm operations may be permitted, as it is not an alteration;

Restoration: site is stable with installed silt fences and erosion controls, retaining walls, near water; river must be delineated and flagged; NOI would be required for work within RFA; could restoration plantings be bundled into NOI for other work?—answer is yes;

Property owner and wetlands consultant will submit a plan within a couple of months;

Farming in a Wetlands Resource Area (check into this); House plans across the road: will also be delineated

5. New Business: Kate Bednaz, Freshwater Wetland Services, on behalf of 70 Peninsula Rd. (scheduled NOI hearing for May 20, 2026—schedule SITE VISIT

Special Meeting to be held May 13, 2026

6. Agenda next mtg to Town Clerk's mailbox: Agenda/Notice will be sent to Town Clerk for May 20, 2026

7. Adjourn: 8:15